Foam rolling — upper body rest day (hEDS / HSD safe)

Myofascial release only · no joint mobilization · matched to upper body routine · ~14 min · 9 areas

Target area

T-spine / traps · Chest / shoulder · Lats · Biceps / triceps · Forearms

⚠ hEDS / HSD foam rolling rules

Roll on muscle bellies only — never on joints, tendons, or bony prominences. Avoid direct rib pressure (subluxation risk). Wall-based ball work preferred for pressure control. Tennis ball first.

Phase 1 — Thoracic spine + scapular region (~5 min)

1 Upper back — thoracic extensors — 45s each dir · Foam roller · ~2 min

Erector spinae · rhomboids · mid/lower traps

Lie on roller across upper back, knees bent, arms crossed.
Roll mid-back to shoulder blades. Pause 5–8s on tight spots.
hEDS: keep core braced — don't hyperextend over roller. Small ROM only.

2 Rhomboids + mid-traps (ball against wall) — 30s × 2–3 spots · Tennis ball · ~3 min

Rhomboids · mid-trap — loaded by rows (ex. 2, 4, 6)

Ball between spine and shoulder blade. Lean in gently, small circles. Find 2–3 tender spots per side.
hEDS: wall-based for pressure control. Never on spine directly.

Phase 2 — Chest, lats + shoulder complex (~4.5 min)

3 Pec major + pec minor (ball against wall) — 30–40s per side · Tennis ball · ~2 min

Pec major · pec minor — tight from press (ex. 3, 5)

Ball below collarbone on pec muscle. Lean in gently, make slow arm movements (raise overhead, sweep out).
hEDS: light pressure, stay medial on belly. Stop if shoulder shifts.

4 Lats (side-lying on roller) — 40s per side · Foam roller · ~2 min

Latissimus dorsi — loaded by all rowing + hang work

Lie on side, roller under armpit on lat. Extend arm overhead.
Roll from armpit to mid-rib slowly. Switch sides.
hEDS: stay on meaty lat behind ribcage — avoid direct rib pressure.

5 Posterior shoulder + infraspinatus (ball against wall) — 20–30s per side · Tennis ball · ~1.5 min

Infraspinatus · teres minor · post. delt — from CARs + rows

Ball on back of shoulder, below scapular spine, on flat muscle area. Gentle lean and small circles.
hEDS: very gentle only. Skip next time if shoulder feels unstable.

Phase 3 — Arms + forearms (~4 min)

6 Triceps (ball against wall or on table) — 30s per arm · Tennis ball · ~1.5 min

All 3 heads — from bench, incline, pushdowns (ex. 3, 5, 8)

Back of upper arm on ball. Roll from mid-arm toward shoulder. Focus on the meaty mid-portion.
hEDS: avoid elbow joint — stay on muscle belly. Light pressure only.

7 Biceps (ball on table) — 20–30s per arm · Tennis ball · ~1.5 min

Biceps brachii · brachialis — from curls + pulling (ex. 4, 6, 7)

Front of upper arm on ball on table.
Roll mid-arm to below shoulder. Very light pressure.
hEDS: biceps tendon is vulnerable — mid-belly only. Skip if elbow loose.

8 Forearm extensors + flexors (ball on table) — 20s per surface · Tennis ball · ~2 min

Wrist extensors · flexors — supports wrist CARs + iso loading

Forearm on ball: palm up (flexors) then palm down (extensors).
Roll mid-forearm to 3cm above wrist. Gentle pressure.
hEDS: stay well away from wrist joint. Complements iso loading.

Finish — Upper trap release (~1.5 min · always last)

9 Upper traps + levator scapulae (ball against wall) — 30–40s per side · Tennis ball · ~1.5 min

Upper trapezius · levator scapulae — tight from desk + pressing

Ball on upper trap ridge (between neck and shoulder tip).
Lean in and breathe slowly. Sustained hold, no active rolling.
hEDS: never on neck itself. Stay on muscular ridge. Reposition if tingling.

Quick reference — exercise ↔ foam rolling map

Bench press / incline press	→ Pec release (#3), Triceps (#6), Upper back (#1)
Cable rows / DB rows	→ Rhomboids (#2), Lats (#4), Biceps (#7)
Band pull-aparts / ext. rotation	→ Posterior shoulder (#5), Upper traps (#9)
Curls / pushdowns	→ Biceps (#7), Triceps (#6), Forearms (#8)
Wrist CARs / iso loading	→ Forearm extensors + flexors (#8)
Active hang / Y-T-W holds	→ Lats (#4), Posterior shoulder (#5), Rhomboids (#2)
Lateral raise / chest fly	→ Posterior shoulder (#5), Pec release (#3)

hEDS / HSD foam rolling rules — every session

- Roll on muscle bellies only — never on joints, tendons, bony prominences, or directly on ribs
- Wall-based ball work preferred — gives you full pressure control vs floor-based
- Use tennis ball first — upgrade to lacrosse ball only after 3–4 weeks of known tolerance
- At 58kg no extra loading needed — your bodyweight provides sufficient pressure
- If any area feels MORE loose/unstable after rolling — skip it next session and tell your physio

Schedule + equipment

Rest days only (non-gym days) · ideally evening · ~14 min total

Equipment: 1 standard foam roller + 1 tennis ball (upgrade to lacrosse ball after 3–4 weeks)

This is soft tissue work only — your CARs / iso holds / Y-T-W protocol stays on gym days